Feature demo · narration that travels

A shared deck can speak now.

Everything built for “the deck presents itself” stopped at the Studio boundary. The author heard the narration; the board received a silent file.

> *The product claim is a deck that presents itself to a board member. That deck is silent. Its most carefully engineered component is a progress bar nobody sees.*

— THE MUNGER-INVERSION LENS, THREE REVIEWS RUNNING

What actually reaches a recipient.

BEFORE

A self-contained webpage with three views, captions, and no sound. The voice ladder read the *viewer's* key, so anyone without one floored to silent.



AFTER

The same single file, carrying the author's own voice inline. It plays with no key, no account, and no network.

Both files are self-contained. The difference is whether the recipient can hear the presentation the author actually rehearsed.

The contract

Every sentence, or none of them.

01 **The device answers first**

Each sentence rehearsed in Present is already stored, and costs nothing to ship.

02 **The rest is recorded at export**

Whatever is missing is synthesized before the file is written, and kept for next time.

03 **An incomplete set is refused**

A deck that goes quiet halfway through is worse than one that never spoke.

Why refusing is kinder

A silence you can fix beats one your audience discovers.

“Forty-two of forty-seven sentences have audio” is a number the author reads and dismisses. The missing five are what their board hears. So the failure moves back to the machine where it can still be repaired.

Two switches, four files

Captions and audio are separate choices.

01

Captions alone

A teleprompter read-along on the player's own clock.

02

Audio alone

The deck speaks and turns its own pages, unwatched.

03

Both

The voice, and the line it is reading, in step.

Whose voice, whose rhythm

The performance becomes a property of the artifact.

The narrator defaults to the voice the deck was rehearsed in, and can be changed for one export. This deck asks for a deliberate pace, and the file holds that same beat between slides — the directorial choice travels rather than being re-decided by whichever browser opens it.

Where the audio rides

Inline, in its own blocks — not inside the manifest.

01

Still one file

Inline `data:` URIs. No sidecar, no network origin.

02

Not in the envelope

It base64s itself whole, so audio there would encode twice.

03

Parsed one slide at a time

You pay for the slide in front of you, not the deck.

The privacy interaction

Stripping speaker notes leaves narration alone.

Narration is generated from what is on the slide, so a note has nothing to do with it — stripping notes removes them from the shared file and the caption track ships as usual. The two used to be mutually exclusive, back when a note outranked the slide's own content; a recipient who needs captions no longer pays for an author's privacy.

Still open

The rail should follow the voice.

The readiness band lives only in the React overlay, while a shared file rides the vanilla transport. It now belongs somewhere both can read — which is, finally, where its audience is.